

# Identity Graph Logic (IGL) vs. Knowledge Graph Products

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Knowledge graphs are sold today as **data products** — Neo4j, Stardog, Amazon Neptune, Microsoft Graph and their peers organize entities and relationships so humans and models can *query what is known*. Identity Graph Logic is a **control plane**: the graph exists so that every AI action can be bound to *who is acting, under whose authority, within what coverage* — deterministically, at runtime.

| Dimension                 | Knowledge Graph (as sold today)                                                                     | Identity Graph Logic (IGL)                                                                                                                    |
|---------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Core question             | "What is known about this entity, and how is it connected?"                                         | "Who is acting — <b>who am I, who are we</b> — under whose authority, and within what coverage?"                                              |
| Primary artifact          | Queryable graph of facts and entities (property graph / RDF), optimized for traversal and analytics | Governed digital representation of a person or company: identity, ownership, authority, delegation, resources, policies                       |
| Primary consumer          | Analysts, search, recommendations, entity resolution, RAG context fed into LLMs                     | Runtime enforcement for AI models, agents, and MCP tools — the graph is consulted before every material action                                |
| Truth model               | Asserted plus inferred edges; probabilistic enrichment and fuzzy matching are acceptable            | Deterministic: authority is computed by UDM — explainable, reproducible, no inference at decision time                                        |
| Output of a query         | Records, paths, similarity scores                                                                   | An allow/deny decision, bounded coverage, and an audit record tied to identity lineage                                                        |
| Identity semantics        | People and organizations appear as <i>data subjects</i> — things described                          | People and organizations are <i>principals</i> — actors holding keys, delegations, and obligations                                            |
| Change and revocation     | Data updates propagate on ingestion cycles; eventual consistency is normal                          | Revocation propagates across models, agents, tools, and live sessions; keys reference current authority state                                 |
| Delegation                | Not native — delegation can only be stored as more data                                             | First-class: user→agent and cross-graph delegation without merging graphs; derived authority can only be equal to or narrower than its source |
| Commercial buyer          | Data engineering, analytics, and AI-context teams                                                   | Compliance / risk owner with the CISO — deterministic auditability is a compliance purchase                                                   |
| Relationship between them | A knowledge graph can serve as substrate or enrichment source for the Identity Graph                | IGL is the enforcement layer a KG cannot become: authority computation, key semantics, and the AI+MCP enforcement chain                       |

**Bottom line.** Knowledge graphs organize **what is known**. Identity Graph Logic governs **who may act**. A KG can inform the Identity Graph — it cannot replace deterministic authority computation, live key semantics, or runtime enforcement.

# IOS+ (MCP Bridge / Gateway Server) vs. OpenRouter-Class AI Gateways

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OpenRouter and similar AI gateways solved **model access**: one API, one credential, many providers, with routing, fallback, budgets, and logging. IOS+ is the **MCP Bridge / Gateway Server** in the IGL stack: it governs **action** — every tool call, data touch, and delegated operation — under authority computed from the Identity Graph. The two control points answer different questions.

| Dimension                  | OpenRouter-class AI gateway                                                  | IOS+ — MCP Bridge / Gateway Server                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Control point              | Model requests: which LLM API gets called, at what cost, with which fallback | Action execution: which agent may invoke which tool, on which resource, under whose identity — plus which models may participate                                                                                                         |
| What the key means         | A credential carrying credits, quota, and rate limits                        | A scoped bearer key that <b>references live, graph-derived authority state</b> — not a static secret                                                                                                                                     |
| Questions asked at runtime | Is this key valid? Can it call this model? Is it under budget?               | Which identity does this key represent? Which graph governs it? What authority was computed? Which model version is authorized? May this model use this MCP tool? Is the delegation still valid — and from which graph did it originate? |
| Model governance           | Catalog access across providers, routing, fallback, cost caps                | Exact model-version activation bound to the identity's coverage; model participation is itself an authorization decision                                                                                                                 |
| Tool governance            | Out of scope — AI gateways do not enforce MCP tool calls                     | Native: per-tool, per-parameter authority derived from the Identity Graph through the MCP bridge                                                                                                                                         |
| Enforcement basis          | Gateway policy configuration (limits, guardrails, DLP rules)                 | Deterministic authority computed by UDM <b>outside model reasoning</b> — the same boundaries on every approved model                                                                                                                     |
| Audit                      | Request/response logs for billing and observability                          | Deterministic, replayable action audit tied to identity lineage across models, tools, and sessions                                                                                                                                       |
| Delegation                 | None — API keys are shared secrets, transferable by copy                     | User→agent and cross-graph delegation, attenuation-only, revocable, with propagation across sessions                                                                                                                                     |
| Commercial buyer           | Developers and platform engineering optimizing cost and access               | Compliance / risk and platform teams operating governed AI — a compliance purchase, not an access purchase                                                                                                                               |
| Relationship between them  | Can serve as an upstream model route underneath IOS+                         | IOS+ governs what a model gateway cannot see: tools, data, delegation, and the identity behind every call                                                                                                                                |

**Bottom line.** AI gateways commoditize **access to models**. IOS+ governs **action under identity**. The categories will converge — gateways are already adding identity features — but identity bolted onto a gateway is policy configuration; identity at the foundation is architecture.

Category descriptions reflect publicly documented product positioning as of August 2026; verify vendor claims against dated sources before external distribution. Internal use — apionekey.com / IOS.